

during second and subsequent semester will be subject to satisfactory academic performance by the student, as per standards laid by the Institute.

■ INTERNATIONAL CO-OPERATION

The Institute has initiated action to enter into international co-operation with a number of premier institutions in Europe and USA. An MOU with Ecole Polytechnique, France has already been signed. Under this, both students and faculty exchange programmes have been agreed upon.

■ ACADEMICS

IIST has in place, a very effective mentoring system to guide, support and enhance the student learning process. The Institute provides ample opportunities for Faculty, Students and Researchers to have scientific and academic interaction with eminent scientists in the country and abroad.

■ STUDY OF MINORS

The undergraduate students who maintain a good academic record will have an opportunity to choose a set of three subjects called the "Minor" during 5th, 6th and 7th semesters. The study of minors will provide additional knowledge and skill in certain specialized areas to students, so as to enhance the knowledge base in their professional career.

■ SPECIAL PRACTICAL CLASSES

In addition to the regular practical experiments forming part of any undergraduate courses in science and engineering, IIST has developed certain Special practical sessions carved out of real life experiments in space programmes being conducted in ISRO Centres/Units.

■ INTERNSHIP

The Institute provides the opportunity to all students to undertake Internship during their winter and summer vacations in the laboratories of ISRO Centres/Units. The internship is for a period of 4-6 weeks with the clear definition of a project in the area of interest. At the end of the internship, students will prepare a Technical Report detailing the findings of the experiments, which will be presented before a group of experts.

■ STUDENT PROJECTS

At IIST, students are encouraged to work on mini projects which would expose them to various technical challenges involved in solving complex problems. The on-going Student Projects are in the areas of Robotics, Unmanned Aerial Vehicle, Advanced Solar Cell, Autonomous Firefighter, etc. The Institute has also started two big projects on development of a Sounding Rocket and a Micro Satellite.

■ RESEARCH ACTIVITIES

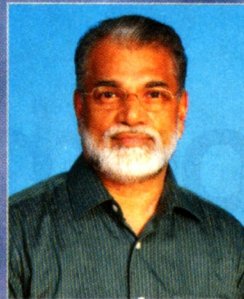
IIST is committed to seamlessly integrate research with education in the advanced fields of Space Science and Technology. The Institute actively encourages the faculty and research fellows to undertake research projects in their field of expertise, so that IIST can contribute significantly to the R&D support needed for future ISRO missions.

■ NEW CAMPUS

The Institute presently functions from a specially created Alternative Campus, adjacent to the Vikram Sarabhai Space Centre, Thiruvananthapuram. IIST's permanent campus is being established at Valiamala, about 20 kms from Thiruvananthapuram city. The first phase of this modern campus, set in a beautiful natural landscape, will be ready for occupation by early 2010. The campus, planned with a built up area of 1,20,000 sq. m shall house 4 Academic Blocks with classrooms, research laboratories and computer centres, Library, Administrative Block, Convocation Area, Student Activity Centre, Hostels, Sports and Recreation facilities and residential area for faculty & non-teaching staff.

■ ADMISSION

Admission to the B Tech Programmes in IIST is through an All India Entrance Test. ISAT-2010 will be conducted in about 30 centres across India on 16 April, 2010. Aspiring students have to first register themselves at the ISAT-2010 website (www.iist.ac.in/IIST/ISAT2010/) or at the alternative website, (www.isac.gov.in/iist) and then submit the required documents by post. The Test will consist of 2 papers of 2 hours duration each, with equal number of questions on Physics, Chemistry and Mathematics.



INTALKWITH

DR. K. RADHAKRISHNAN
Chairman, ISRO

■ You have been associated with IIST from its very beginning, first as a Member of the Board of Management and now as its Chairman. Why was it necessary for Department of Space to start its own academic institution?

This is an exciting time for space science and technology in India. We have reached the moon, but there are formidable challenges ahead, which will include human space missions, planetary explorations, low cost access to space and more sophisticated earth observation and communication satellites. The young scientist can look forward to a wonderful career filled with excitement, exploration and opportunities. This exponential phase of the Indian space programme can be sustained only with a regular inflow of high quality human capital. The genesis of Indian Institute of Space Science and Technology (IIST) has to be viewed in this context.

■ In what manner will ISRO/Dept. of Space support IIST?

IIST is an autonomous body, fully funded by the Department of Space (DOS). The complete cost of education for the students of IIST is borne by Department of Space through an Assistanceship Package. DOS also gives the commitment to absorb every student passing out of IIST with the specified academic performance as Scientist/Engineer C. From 2012 onwards, about 40% of the annual intake of Scientists and Engineers for ISRO is expected to be through IIST. The laboratories, libraries and other facilities of ISRO will be available for IIST students and faculty for educational and research purposes. Department of Space and ISRO are fully committed to the dream of making IIST a world-class educational institution.

■ What are your expectations from IIST?

IIST is maturing into a quality academic institution and is successful in the selection of high quality teachers and researchers, in tune with the expectations of ISRO. Besides being the supplier of quality human resources for ISRO, IIST is expected to produce outstanding research output to back the future Missions of ISRO. I am sure that someday it will evolve into the academic backbone of India's space programme. I also wish to see IIST emerging as a world-class academic institution in its own right.

